

INTERNAL MEMORANDUM

Ref: KIPRE/PSD/03/07/2026

Date: 17th July 2026

To: Ag. Deputy Directors, Research and Administration
Senior Scientists

From: Head, Planning and Strategy Division 

SUBJECT: PREPARATION OF KIPRE'S RESPONSE TO THE NATIONAL ASSEMBLY DEPARTMENTAL COMMITTEE ON HEALTH FACT-FINDING VISIT – MEETING ON MONDAY, 20TH JULY 2026 AT 1:30 PM

As shared by the Director General/CEO, the National Assembly's Departmental Committee on Health (Ref: NA/DDC/DC-H/2026/65, dated 14 July 2026) will undertake a fact-finding visit to KIPRE on Wednesday, 22 July 2026, comprising fifteen (15) Members of Parliament and seven (7) Parliamentary staff. The Committee has outlined twelve (12) specific issues it intends to examine, spanning our legal framework, research priorities, infrastructure, compliance, commercialization, financing, inter-agency coordination, and national health security contribution, among others.

To ensure KIPRE is fully prepared to respond comprehensively and accurately, all Heads of Department from the Research Divisions and Administration are requested to attend a preparatory meeting as follows:

Date: Monday, 20th July 2026 **Time:** 1:30 PM **Venue:** Conference Hall

Attendance: All Heads of Directorates and Divisions

The purpose of the meeting is to deliberate on the twelve (12) issues raised by the Committee (detailed in the table below), assign leads for each issue, agree on the information required from each division, and commission a comprehensive institutional report in readiness for the visit on 22 July 2026.

The Twelve (12) Issues Raised by the Committee

#	Issue	As Raised by the Committee
1	Adequacy of the legal and institutional framework	Whether the existing legal and institutional framework is sufficient to support KIPRE's evolving mandate – preclinical biomedical research, vaccine and drug development, antimicrobial resistance, One Health research, reproductive health innovation, and locally appropriate antivenoms – and what legislative or policy measures may be needed.
2	Research priorities and alignment	KIPRE's current research priorities and how they support national health priorities in vaccine development, drug discovery, emerging/re-emerging infectious diseases, antimicrobial resistance, reproductive health and One Health.



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MINISTRY OF HEALTH

#	Issue	As Raised by the Committee
3	Infrastructure and capacity	Adequacy of laboratory infrastructure, animal facilities, specialised equipment and scientific personnel for high-quality preclinical research, and the key capacity gaps.
4	Animal welfare, ethics and biosafety	Measures in place to ensure compliance with national and international standards on animal welfare, research ethics, biosafety and biosecurity in the use of non-human primates.
5	Translation and commercialization	Progress in translating research into health products, technologies and policy (vaccines, therapeutics, diagnostics, antivenoms) and the barriers impeding commercialization and technology transfer.
6	Budgetary adequacy	Whether current budgetary allocations are adequate to support KIPRE's statutory mandate and strategic priorities, and the principal recurrent, development and research financing gaps.
7	Inter-agency coordination	How KIPRE coordinates its work with the Ministry of Health, KEMRI, BioVax Institute, the Pharmacy and Poisons Board, the National Quality Control Laboratory, universities, County Governments and international partners, and any coordination or mandate gaps.
8	Kenya-US Health Cooperation Framework	KIPRE's assigned role under the Framework, particularly research collaboration, laboratory strengthening, workforce development, technology transfer and product development.
9	Research sovereignty and IP safeguards	Safeguards in place to protect Kenya's biological materials, genomic data, intellectual property rights and research sovereignty in collaborative research with international partners.
10	Local manufacture agenda	How KIPRE is supporting the Government's agenda on local manufacture of vaccines, biological products, diagnostics and antivenoms, and additional investments or partnerships required.
11	National health security preparedness	How KIPRE supports national preparedness and response to emerging infectious diseases and other public health threats through research, surveillance and development of medical countermeasures.
12	Legislative, policy, institutional and financial interventions	What interventions KIPRE considers necessary to strengthen Kenya's biomedical research ecosystem and enhance its contribution to national health security, innovation and Universal Health Coverage.

Preparatory Action Required Before the Meeting

Heads of Divisions are requested to liaise with the Senior Research Scientists/staff in their respective divisions ahead of Monday's meeting, to collect and collate any information, data, ongoing projects, achievements, statistics or documentation that may respond to any of the twelve (12) issues above. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Ongoing and completed research projects relevant to the issues, with their outputs and impact.
- Infrastructure, equipment and personnel capacity within the division, including any gaps.
- Compliance records on animal welfare, research ethics, biosafety and biosecurity.
- Partnerships, collaborations and coordination arrangements with MoH, KEMRI, BioVax, PPB, NQCL, universities, County Governments and international partners.
- Any engagement to date under the Kenya–United States Health Cooperation Framework.
- Budgetary and financing gaps affecting the division's ability to deliver its mandate.
- Any other information that would help demonstrate KIPRE's contribution to national health security, innovation and Universal Health Coverage.

Divisions are encouraged to bring this information, however preliminary, to Monday's meeting so that it can be consolidated into a single, comprehensive institutional report ahead of the Committee's visit.

Thank you.

cc:

Director General / Chief Executive Officer

Ag. Director, Research and Product Development Directorate

Ag. Director, Animal Science, Welfare and Ethics Directorate

Ag. Director, Capacity Building, Partnerships and Grants Management Directorate